

JHARKHAND

ON THE PATH OF GOOD GOVERNANCE

Since it was carved out of Bihar on November 15, 2000, Jharkhand has always been the state with a rare equilibrium: it has about 2.4 per cent of the country's geographical area and a matching 2.7 per cent of the national population.

Jharkhand has nearly 40 per cent of the nation's mineral resources, which includes the country's 29% coal reserve. All Jharkhand needed was decisive and inspiring leadership to harness the State's massive potential to grow. In December 2019, the state elected for itself the visionary leadership of Hemant Soren. Now, in December 2021, when the Chief Minister will complete two years in office, it is a good time to take a look at his ideas to take Jharkhand forward.

CORE IDEAS: GOOD GOVERNANCE

The Chief Minister's idea of development is perfectly expressed in his innovative programme called "Apke Adhikar, Apki Sarkar, Apke Dwar" (your rights, your government, at your doorstep), announced on the eve of Jharkhand's Statehood Day on November 15, also the birth anniversary of tribal icon Birsa Munda and the carving out of Jharkhand from erstwhile Bihar.

The programme is the biggest citizen outreach and public services delivery campaign in Jharkhand. It has been rolled out across all 4,562 panchayats of Jharkhand with 2,514,697 applications registered of which 1,845,608 applications already addressed. The idea is to create awareness, redress grievances and focus on service delivery of important state government schemes in 10 key sectoral areas.

The key sectoral areas identified include housing where of 490,434 applications received 287,027 have already been implemented; food supplies and PDS (new ration card applications, distribution of ration cards, resolution of ration card related errors or corrections, resolve PDS dealer-related issues and effective implementation of Dhoti, Saree distribution scheme) where out of 459,825 received 354,964 implemented; pension and social security where 74% applications are addressed; MGNREGA (new job card application, priority to migrant workers on job cards, disbursal of insurance cover for workers); rural development (identifying women selling country liquor and embedding them under livelihood projects, public work plan to be accepted, vetted and approved under 15th Finance Commission funds at gram pradhan level, distribution of blankets to the vulnerable); agriculture and animal husbandry; and health (vaccination camps, diagnostic health and eye check-up camps, anaemia and malnutrition check-up camps, enrolment and approval of applications under health insurance coverage and maternal health coverage schemes) where 92% of applications registered has been disposed.

The other important sectors include land and land-related issues, registration of workers from unorganised sectors under e-shram portal and priority to Right to Service Guarantee Act (caste certificate, income certificate, all issues regarding enrolment and benefits receipt of social welfare delivery schemes).

The government's intention is to resolve the problems of rural masses at their doorsteps.

